



NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (NCIE) INDIA

Flagship Innovation Leadership Guidelines

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation & Grant Lifecycle

Detailed operational guidelines for course-integrated tracks, 8-stage startup validation lifecycle, Rs. 5 Lakh milestone seed grant model, and follow-on venture capital / investor connectivity pipeline.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTERIAL COORDINATION & ALIGNMENT

MSDE

Skill Development &
Entrepreneurship

MSME

Micro, Small &
Medium Enterprises

MeitY

Electronics &
Information Technology

MCA

Ministry of
Corporate Affairs

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SUPPORTING NATIONAL INITIATIVES & STRATEGIC ALLIANCES



NCIE VIKSIT BHARAT @2047 INNOVATION LEADERSHIP PROGRAMME

Programme Overview

The NCIE Viksit Bharat @2047 Innovation Leadership Programme is a structured, course-integrated programme designed to develop **innovation, technology, Artificial Intelligence, entrepreneurship, business and leadership capabilities** among students and young professionals.

The programme is intended particularly for participants from the **engineering and technology domain**, while providing a broader framework for developing future-ready innovation and entrepreneurial capabilities.

The programme connects academic learning with **practical projects, innovation activities, technology awareness, entrepreneurship and leadership development**, contributing within NCIE's organisational framework to the broader national aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Programme Tracks

1. Innovation & Technology Management

Focus areas include:

- Innovation management
- Technology management
- Design thinking
- Problem-solving
- Emerging technologies
- Innovation strategy
- Technology-enabled solutions
- Project-based innovation

2. AI, Business & Startup Innovation

Focus areas include:

- Artificial Intelligence awareness
- AI applications
- AI-enabled business solutions
- Digital innovation

- Entrepreneurial thinking
- Startup innovation
- Business model development
- Technology-enabled entrepreneurship

Programme Objectives

The programme aims to:

- Develop innovation and leadership capabilities.
- Build awareness of emerging technologies.
- Introduce participants to Artificial Intelligence and its applications.
- Develop entrepreneurial and business-oriented thinking.
- Encourage practical problem-solving.
- Promote innovation projects and technology-based solutions.
- Connect academic learning with practical applications.
- Develop future-ready professional capabilities.
- Encourage students to explore entrepreneurship and startup opportunities.

Programme Delivery

The programme may be delivered through:

- Online classes
- Offline institutional sessions
- Hybrid learning
- Workshops
- Seminars
- Expert sessions
- Practical activities
- Project-based learning
- Mentorship

Delivery may be organised through participating educational institutions and appropriate regional programme arrangements.

Programme Learning Pathway

LEARN



UNDERSTAND



INNOVATE**BUILD****APPLY****LEAD****Programme Components****Innovation**

Participants explore innovation methodologies, problem identification and solution development.

Technology

Participants gain exposure to technology management and emerging technology applications.

Artificial Intelligence

Participants develop foundational awareness and application-oriented understanding of AI.

Business

Participants explore business fundamentals, opportunity identification and technology-enabled business models.

Entrepreneurship

Participants are introduced to startup thinking, idea development and entrepreneurial opportunities.

Leadership

Participants develop communication, teamwork, decision-making and leadership capabilities.

Practical Learning

Where applicable, participants may undertake:

- Innovation projects
- Technology projects
- Business case studies
- AI-based activities
- Startup ideas
- Presentations
- Innovation challenges
- Team projects

Registration

One-Time Registration Fee: ₹700 per course

The ₹700 amount is presented as the **one-time registration fee for the applicable course/programme track**. The exact course structure, duration, eligibility and participation requirements should be stated in the applicable programme circular or registration notice.

Target Participants

The programme may be intended for:

- Engineering students
- Technology students
- Undergraduate students
- Young professionals
- Student innovators
- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Innovation-oriented learners
- Participants interested in AI and emerging technologies

Expected Outcomes

Participants may develop:

- Innovation awareness
- Technology awareness
- AI literacy
- Entrepreneurial thinking
- Business understanding
- Leadership capabilities
- Problem-solving skills

- Project development experience
- Startup orientation

Viksit Bharat @2047 Contribution

The programme is designed around the development of **future-ready youth, innovation capabilities, technology awareness and entrepreneurship**, contributing within NCIE's organisational framework to the broader aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.

Contribution Pathway

EDUCATION



SKILLS



INNOVATION



ENTREPRENEURSHIP



LEADERSHIP



ECONOMIC PARTICIPATION

Programme Position

The programme should be understood according to the applicable NCIE programme documents, circulars and institutional arrangements. Reference to **Viksit Bharat @2047 or Government initiatives represents the stated alignment framework and should not independently be interpreted as Government accreditation, Government employment, statutory Government status or guaranteed Government funding unless supported by specific official documentation.**

DR. A.P.J. ABDUL KALAM STARTUP VALIDATION PROGRAMME

Programme Overview

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** is an NCIE initiative designed to support **student innovators, aspiring entrepreneurs, early-stage founders and innovation-oriented institutions** in progressing innovative ideas towards validation and startup development.

The programme provides a structured pathway covering:

IDEA → INNOVATION → PROTOTYPE → VALIDATION → MENTORSHIP → INCUBATION → INVESTOR READINESS → STARTUP DEVELOPMENT

Programme Objectives

The programme aims to:

- Encourage innovation and entrepreneurial thinking.
- Identify promising student and youth-led ideas.
- Support development of innovative solutions.
- Provide appropriate mentorship and expert guidance.
- Facilitate prototype and proof-of-concept development.
- Support market and problem validation.
- Develop entrepreneurial capabilities.
- Facilitate appropriate incubation and acceleration linkages.
- Prepare suitable ventures for investor engagement.
- Strengthen institutional innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems.

Startup Validation Framework

STAGE 1 – IDEA IDENTIFICATION

Identification and initial documentation of innovative ideas addressing:

- Social problems
- Technology challenges
- Business opportunities
- Community needs
- Industry problems
- Emerging market opportunities

STAGE 2 – IDEA DEVELOPMENT

Participants develop:

- Problem statement
- Proposed solution
- Target users
- Value proposition
- Initial business concept

STAGE 3 – PROTOTYPING

Where appropriate, participants may develop:

- Prototype
- Minimum viable product
- Proof of concept
- Demonstration model

STAGE 4 – VALIDATION

The idea may be evaluated against:

- Problem relevance
- Innovation
- Technical feasibility
- Market potential
- User need
- Scalability
- Business viability

STAGE 5 – MENTORSHIP

Suitable participants may receive access to appropriate:

- Startup mentors
- Industry experts
- Technology experts
- Entrepreneurs
- Academic experts

STAGE 6 – INCUBATION LINKAGE

Eligible ventures may be facilitated towards suitable:

- Incubators
- Accelerators

- Innovation centres
- Startup ecosystems
- Industry networks

STAGE 7 – INVESTOR READINESS

Promising ventures may be supported in preparing:

- Business model
- Pitch presentation
- Market information
- Financial assumptions
- Product information
- Startup profile
- Investor-readiness materials

STAGE 8 – ECOSYSTEM & INVESTOR CONNECTIVITY

Suitable and investor-ready ventures may be facilitated for engagement with appropriate:

- Investors
- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Industry partners
- Startup networks
- Funding ecosystems

Indicative Startup Support

The NCIE programme framework provides for **startup seed-support mechanisms of up to ₹5,00,000 for selected eligible startup initiatives**, subject to programme guidelines, evaluation, selection, milestones and availability of resources.

Potential support areas may include:

- Idea validation
- Prototype development
- MVP development
- Proof of concept
- Product development

- Market validation
- Startup mentoring
- Business model development
- Incubation linkage

Investor Ecosystem Linkage

Suitable ventures may be facilitated towards potential investor engagement after appropriate validation and investor-readiness preparation.

Indicative Investment Pipeline

UP TO ₹25 CRORE

The ₹25 crore figure should be presented as an **indicative potential investment pipeline / ecosystem connectivity target across eligible and investor-ready opportunities**, and **not as guaranteed investment capital available to each startup**.

Any investment remains subject to:

- Investor interest
- Due diligence
- Business viability
- Market opportunity
- Technology readiness
- Financial assessment
- Applicable legal and regulatory requirements
- Investment terms
- Independent investor decision

Investor Connectivity Pathway

STARTUP IDEA



VALIDATION



PROTOTYPE / MVP



MENTORSHIP



BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT**INVESTOR READINESS****INCUBATOR / ACCELERATOR LINKAGE****INVESTOR PITCH****DUE DILIGENCE****POTENTIAL INVESTMENT****SCALE-UP****Institutional Innovation & Entrepreneurship Support**

The programme may also support eligible colleges and universities in strengthening their innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystem.

Potential areas include:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student startup programmes
- Prototype development
- Innovation challenges
- Hackathons
- Entrepreneurship training
- AI and digital innovation
- Faculty development
- Industry–academia initiatives

Institutional Funding Facilitation

NCIE may facilitate eligible institutions in identifying appropriate funding opportunities through applicable:

- Government Ministry / Department programmes
- Government-supported schemes

- CSR partnerships
- Industry-supported initiatives
- Innovation and incubation mechanisms
- Institutional development programmes
- Philanthropic and development organisations

Indicative Institutional Funding Requirement

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

This represents an **indicative funding-support range for eligible institutional proposals** and is not an automatic or guaranteed Government, Ministry or CSR grant.

Actual funding depends upon:

**ELIGIBILITY → PROPOSAL → EVALUATION → FUNDING
SOURCE → APPROVAL → AVAILABILITY OF FUNDS**

Institutional Convergence Model

COLLEGE / UNIVERSITY



NEED ASSESSMENT



PROJECT PROPOSAL



TECHNICAL / PROGRAMME FACILITATION



**GOVERNMENT / CSR / INDUSTRY / OTHER ELIGIBLE FUNDING
CHANNEL**



EVALUATION



APPROVAL



FUNDING / SUPPORT



IMPLEMENTATION



MONITORING & IMPACT

Participant Categories

The programme may be relevant to:

- Student innovators
- Student entrepreneurs
- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Early-stage founders
- Researchers
- Technology innovators
- College and university innovation teams
- Institutional innovation cells

Expected Outcomes

The programme aims to facilitate:

- Validated startup ideas
- Prototypes and proof of concepts
- Entrepreneurial capabilities
- Startup-ready teams
- Mentorship connections
- Incubation opportunities
- Investor readiness
- Industry exposure
- Institutional innovation capacity

Overall Programme Pathway

IDEA

Identify a meaningful problem or opportunity.



INNOVATE

Develop a differentiated solution.



BUILD

Develop prototype / MVP / proof of concept.



VALIDATE

Test technical, user and market assumptions.



MENTOR

Receive appropriate expert and entrepreneurial guidance.



INCUBATE

Connect with suitable incubation and acceleration ecosystems.



INVEST

Facilitate potential investor engagement for suitable ventures.



SCALE

Support appropriate enterprise development and growth.

Programme Disclaimer

The programme's references to startup support, institutional funding and investor connectivity represent **programme frameworks, facilitation mechanisms or indicative opportunities** and do not constitute a guarantee of funding, investment, Government grant, CSR grant or commercial success.

All funding and investment decisions shall remain subject to **eligibility, programme guidelines, proposal evaluation, due diligence, availability of**

resources, applicable laws and regulations, funding terms and the independent decision of the concerned Government authority, CSR organisation, institution, funding agency or investor.

Programme Objective

To create an integrated innovation-to-enterprise pathway that enables students, innovators, early-stage entrepreneurs and eligible institutions to develop, validate and strengthen innovative ideas while facilitating appropriate mentorship, incubation, funding and investor ecosystem connections.

The programme forms part of NCIE's broader **Innovation, Entrepreneurship, Startup Development and Institutional Capacity-Building Framework**, contributing within its organisational mandate to the broader aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.